Flap Surgery

Category: Periodontal / Gum Care Suggested URL:
`/periodontal-gum-care/flap-surgery`

Advanced Gum Treatment to Help Protect Your Teeth

When gum disease progresses, plaque and tartar can collect deep beneath the gum line, damaging the tissues and bone that support your teeth. In these situations, routine cleaning alone may not be enough to manage the problem.

Flap surgery is a periodontal procedure in which the dentist or periodontist gently lifts back a section of gum tissue to access the deeper areas around the teeth. This allows thorough cleaning of the tooth roots and, when needed, treatment of damaged supporting tissues before the gums are repositioned.

The goal is to help control periodontal disease, make affected areas easier to clean and preserve the natural teeth where possible.

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What Is Periodontal Flap Surgery?

Flap surgery is a type of gum surgery used to treat selected cases of moderate to advanced periodontal disease. After the gum tissue is carefully lifted, the dentist can see and access areas that may be difficult to clean with non-surgical treatment alone.

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Depending on the condition of the gums and bone, treatment may involve:

- Removing plaque and hardened tartar from deep periodontal pockets.
- Cleaning contaminated root surfaces.
- Addressing certain irregularities in the supporting bone, when indicated.
- Repositioning and securing the gum tissue to support healing.

Flap surgery is not necessary for everyone with gum disease. A periodontal examination helps determine whether deeper cleaning, surgery or another treatment is appropriate.

When Might Flap Surgery Be Recommended?

A dentist may consider flap surgery when gum disease has affected the deeper tissues supporting the teeth, particularly if non-surgical periodontal treatment has not adequately controlled the condition.

Signs and situations that may require further evaluation include:

- Deep gum pockets: Spaces between the teeth and gums where bacteria accumulate.

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- Persistent gum inflammation: Swelling or bleeding that continues despite appropriate cleaning.

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- Supporting bone loss: Damage to the bone surrounding the teeth due to periodontal disease.

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- Persistent deposits below the gum line: Areas that are difficult to access with routine cleaning.

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- Advanced periodontal disease: Cases where direct access is needed for effective treatment.

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A clinical examination, periodontal pocket measurements and dental X-rays help the dentist assess the extent of the disease and plan treatment.

How Is Flap Surgery Performed?

The procedure is planned according to your gum condition and the areas that need treatment.

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1. Gum assessment and preparation

The dentist evaluates gum pockets, bone support and oral hygiene. Local anaesthesia is used to keep the procedure comfortable.

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2. Accessing the affected area

A small incision allows the gum tissue to be lifted carefully, exposing the root surfaces and supporting tissues beneath it.

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3. Deep cleaning and treatment

Plaque, tartar and diseased deposits are removed from the exposed root surfaces. Additional treatment may be performed if the bone or other supporting tissues require it.

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4. Repositioning the gums

The gum tissue is placed back into position and secured with sutures. Follow-up visits help the dentist monitor healing and remove stitches when appropriate.

Benefits of Flap Surgery

When recommended for the right patient, flap surgery can provide better access to areas affected by periodontal disease.

Potential benefits include:

- Better access for deep cleaning: Helps remove deposits from root surfaces beneath the gums.

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- Improved periodontal health: Can help reduce inflammation and periodontal pocket depth.

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- Support for natural teeth: Helps manage disease that threatens the supporting tissues of the teeth.

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- Treatment of selected bone defects: Additional procedures may be possible when indicated by the bone condition.

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- Easier long-term maintenance: In suitable cases, treatment can make certain areas more manageable during ongoing periodontal care.

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The results depend on the severity of gum disease, the amount of existing bone loss, healing and daily oral hygiene. Flap surgery cannot guarantee that lost bone or gum tissue will grow back.

Recovery and Aftercare

Healing takes time, and the dentist will provide instructions tailored to the surgical area. Mild swelling, tenderness or bleeding can occur during the early recovery period.

To support healing:

- Follow your dentist's instructions for medication and oral hygiene.

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- Eat soft foods initially and avoid chewing directly on the treated area.

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- Avoid smoking or tobacco products during healing.

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- Do not disturb the surgical site or sutures.

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- Use any prescribed mouth rinse only as directed.

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- Attend follow-up appointments to monitor healing and periodontal health.

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Contact your dentist if you experience uncontrolled bleeding, increasing swelling, worsening pain, fever or other concerning symptoms.

Even after successful surgery, gum disease can return without consistent home care and professional periodontal maintenance.

Before and After: Treating Deep Gum Pockets

Before treatment

Deep periodontal pockets and deposits can affect the tissues supporting the teeth.

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After treatment and healing

The treated gum tissue heals around the teeth, with continued monitoring needed.

These images are illustrative, not actual patient results. For the Jerush website, use genuine clinical photographs or X-rays only with appropriate patient consent, and avoid promising identical results for every patient.

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Frequently Asked Questions

1. Is flap surgery necessary for gum disease?

No. Many patients can manage gum disease with non-surgical periodontal treatment and good home care. Surgery may be recommended when deeper areas need additional treatment.

2. Is flap surgery painful?

Local anaesthesia is used during the procedure. Some tenderness or swelling may occur afterwards, and your dentist can advise you on suitable pain relief.

3. How long does flap surgery take?

The duration depends on the number of teeth and the extent of the affected area. Your dentist can provide an estimate after examining your gums.

4. How long does it take for gums to heal?

Initial healing usually takes days to weeks, while complete tissue healing and assessment of the treatment result may take longer. Follow your dentist's recovery instructions.

5. Will flap surgery stop gum disease permanently?

It can help control periodontal disease, but it does not eliminate the need for ongoing care. Daily cleaning and regular professional maintenance remain important.

6. Can flap surgery save loose teeth?

It may help manage the disease affecting a tooth's supporting tissues, but the outcome depends on how much bone support remains and other clinical factors. Severely compromised teeth may have a limited prognosis.

7. Will I need stitches after surgery?

Sutures are commonly used to reposition the gum tissue. Depending on the type, they may dissolve on their own or need to be removed at a follow-up appointment.

Take a Step Towards Healthier Gums at Jerush

Persistent gum bleeding, deep gum pockets and changes in tooth stability should not be ignored. A periodontal assessment can help identify the extent of gum disease and determine whether non-surgical treatment or flap surgery is appropriate.

At Jerush Dentofacial & Cosmetic Laser Centre, your treatment options should be based on your gum health, supporting bone and long-term oral care needs.

Concerned about advanced gum disease? Book a dental consultation to discuss suitable periodontal treatment options.

SEO recommendations

- SEO title: Flap Surgery for Gum Disease | Periodontal Care at Jerush
- Meta description: Learn how periodontal flap surgery helps treat deep gum pockets and manage advanced gum disease. Explore the procedure, recovery and aftercare at Jerush.
- Primary keyword: Flap surgery
- Related keywords: Periodontal flap surgery, gum surgery, advanced gum disease treatment, deep gum pocket treatment, periodontal care
- Suggested image alt text: `Periodontal flap surgery to access and clean deep gum pockets around teeth`